

Case Story – Kusum Pakira

My name is **Kusum Pakira**, and I am from **Bengaluru, Karnataka**. I completed my **Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) in Computer Science and Engineering** from **K S Institute of Technology, Bengaluru**.

I come from a **humble family**, where my parents have made many sacrifices to support my education. Their constant encouragement and belief in me have been the biggest source of strength throughout my journey.

From my college days, I had a strong interest in technology, especially in Artificial Intelligence and software development. My dream was to build a successful career in the IT industry and contribute to innovative technologies. However, after completing my graduation, I realized that academic knowledge alone was not enough to meet industry expectations.

Before joining this program, I faced several challenges. Although I understood the concepts taught in college, I lacked practical exposure, hands-on project experience, and confidence in applying my knowledge to real-world problems. I was also unsure about the latest technologies being used in the industry, interview expectations, resume building, and professional communication. Like many fresh graduates, I often questioned whether I was ready to compete in the job market. These challenges made me realize the importance of structured training, mentorship, and industry guidance.

I came to know about the **NetApp–Nasscom Foundation project implemented by Seventh Sense Talent Solutions** when their team visited our college and introduced the training and placement program. The detailed explanation about the curriculum, practical learning approach, and placement assistance encouraged me to enroll. Another reason that motivated me was that the entire program was **completely free of cost**, making quality technical education and career guidance accessible to students from all backgrounds.

Joining this program became one of the best decisions of my career. The training was well-structured, practical, and industry-oriented. During the program, I learned **Python Programming, Data Preprocessing, Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA), Data Visualization, and AI-Powered Predictive Analytics**. Every topic was taught with practical examples, assignments, and hands-on exercises, enabling me to understand not only the concepts but also their real-world applications.

The trainers encouraged us to think critically, solve problems independently, and continuously improve ourselves. We were given opportunities to work on practical tasks that strengthened our analytical thinking and coding skills. This experience helped me understand how Artificial Intelligence and Data Analytics can be used to solve business problems and support better decision-making.

The program also focused on developing our professional and interpersonal skills. We participated in communication sessions, group discussions, presentations, teamwork activities, and confidence-building exercises. Initially, I was hesitant to speak in front of others and lacked confidence during interviews. Through continuous practice, constructive feedback, and encouragement from the trainers, I gradually became more confident in expressing my ideas, communicating effectively, and presenting my work professionally.

The mentorship provided throughout the program played a major role in my transformation. Whenever I faced difficulties in understanding a concept or preparing for interviews, the trainers patiently guided me, clarified my doubts, and motivated me to keep learning. Their support helped me overcome self-doubt and develop a positive mindset towards learning and career growth.

One of the biggest strengths of this project was the dedicated placement support. We received guidance on preparing professional resumes, improving LinkedIn profiles, solving aptitude questions, attending mock interviews, preparing for technical and HR interviews, and understanding workplace expectations. These sessions helped me understand the complete recruitment process and significantly improved my interview performance.

The knowledge and confidence I gained through this program helped me perform well during placement opportunities. I am extremely happy to share that I have been placed at **Sunfra Technologies** as an **AI Developer**. This achievement is a proud milestone in my life and marks the beginning of my professional journey in the field of Artificial Intelligence. It has given me financial independence, career stability, and the confidence to continue learning and growing in the IT industry.

Looking back, I can confidently say that this project has brought a meaningful transformation to my life. It has improved my technical knowledge, practical skills, communication, presentation abilities, teamwork, problem-solving skills, confidence, and overall personality. Most importantly, it taught me the importance of continuous learning, adaptability, discipline, and believing in myself even during difficult situations.

Today, I feel well-prepared to face professional challenges and contribute effectively to my organization. I am excited to continue expanding my knowledge in Artificial Intelligence and emerging technologies while building a successful career.

I sincerely express my heartfelt gratitude to **NetApp, Nasscom Foundation, and Seventh Sense Talent Solutions** for creating such a valuable initiative for students. This program has not only helped me secure employment but has also shaped me into a more confident, skilled, and career-ready individual. I will always remain grateful for this life-changing opportunity and hope many more students benefit from this wonderful program in the future.